



THE INDIAN DRONE ENTHUSIAST SCENE

So, you wanna be a drone enthusiast? Here's how to go about that in India

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The story of the attraction between people and being airborne has been told too often. Even if one isn't flying themselves, flying objects, especially ones we can control have always attracted us. From fun childhood activities like flying paper aeroplanes and kites, the attraction quite naturally flows towards more sophisticated objects capable of flying today. Drones, quadcopters, UAVs – call them whatever suits your purpose but there's no denying that they have arrived on our shores. While other cover stories in this issue will explore bigger application areas like the military and some really impressive work being done by startups and big companies alike, this one is all about finding out that when it comes to drones, what exactly is happening at the ground level all around you and how can you get involved in the drone scene in India. Let us take you through

the drone enthusiast scene in India on the road to becoming one yourself!

PREREQUISITE KNOWLEDGE

Before you start off, you need to decide what kind of a drone enthusiast you are. The Indian scene – just like any other drone scene in the world – comprises two types of drone geeks. The first kind likes to build the drones from scratch and then fly them, and the second kind gets a pre-made commercial drone and delves into the joy of flying it. Choosing your destination from here will decide which path you trod on, but fear not, we'll take you on a tour of both.

Drone operation is such a practical experience oriented task that it is impossible or ill-advised to go ahead with partial knowledge of how things work. So before you buy your drone or start building one, you should work on getting to know all you can about them. A few years back, the only way you could increase your knowledge about drones

would be to use the internet. Right now there are a number of organisations that conduct drone workshops conducted across the country that you can attend for free or by paying a small amount of money.

These workshops can range across teaching you the basics of aviation to getting you through your own drone build, including the regulations that govern such activities in India. One such company is Skyfilabs, based out of Bangalore. They conduct all kinds of training in technology which includes a range of workshops around drones of multiple kinds. A couple of other organisations like this would be Indian Academy of Drones and the Indian Institute of Drones. Both of them offer training from ex-military drone operators and are recognised by the DGCA.

COMMUNITIES

If getting into a classroom and learning about drones is not your thing, there